

Best exercises for building bigger arms

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 04, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/0bNBQYBOCpU> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs through 9 rapid-fire exercise matchups, picking his preferred move for building bigger arms across both biceps and triceps categories.

Contents

-  Biceps Exercise Picks
-  Triceps Exercise Picks
-  Forearm & Cable Curl Picks

Biceps Exercise Picks 0:00

- **Barbell curl vs. dumbbell curl** → Barbell curl
 - Barbell allows heavier loading and a fixed bilateral movement, favoring overall mass
- **Preacher curl vs. hammer curl** → Preacher curl
 - Preacher curl isolates the biceps at a stretched position, removing shoulder involvement
- **Concentration curl vs. cable curl** → Cable curl
 - Cable maintains constant tension throughout the range of motion, unlike free weights
- **Easy bar curl vs. straight bar curl** → Easy bar curl
 - The angled grip of the EZ bar reduces wrist and elbow strain while still loading the biceps effectively

Triceps Exercise Picks 0:05

- **Triceps dips vs. triceps push downs** → Triceps push downs
 - Push downs provide consistent cable tension and are easier to isolate the triceps without loading the shoulder joint as heavily as dips
- **Skull crushers vs. overhead triceps extensions** → Skull crushers
 - Skull crushers emphasize the long and lateral heads with a strong stretch under load
- **Close grip bench press vs. triceps kickbacks** → Close grip bench press
 - A compound pressing movement that allows significantly heavier loading than isolation kickbacks

Forearm & Cable Curl Picks 0:23

- **Reverse curl vs. Zottman curl** → Reverse curl
 - Targets the brachialis and brachioradialis with a straightforward overhand grip
- **One arm cable curl vs. cross body curl** → One arm cable curl
 - Unilateral cable work maintains constant tension and allows full focus on each arm independently